VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2026

THE TUESDAY PICTURE

Google answers Meta, and a $40,000 exploit rewrites the cyber math

One day after Meta's Muse Wonder, Google shipped Gemini 4 Argon. Sundar Pichai and Demis Hassabis led the launch, Aaron Levie reported a 14-point jump on Box's hardest enterprise tests, and Elon Musk used Pichai's post to argue that executives should talk to customers directly on X. Alexandr Wang spent the day and night on Meta's rollout, apologizing for "the ups and downs" while users posted benchmarks, praise and complaints about cost.

Greg Brockman highlighted XBOW's $250,000 Chrome bounty, won in six days with a public OpenAI model and $40,000 of compute. Aaron Levie and Yann LeCun argued that defenders stand to gain. Paul Graham said a Tesla drove him to the gym "without touching the controls once," and Musk and Ashok Elluswamy amplified it. Musk posted 37 times, mostly about Grok Bot, Starlink and SpaceX; 26 of the 45 builders posted.

I · THE FRONTIER, DAY TWO

Gemini 4 Argon arrives

Google's first Gemini 4 model went on sale worldwide, a day after Meta's, with an introductory price and a long list of real-world results.

$2 / $10
Introductory price per million input and output tokens, rising to $4 / $20 after November 30

1M
Unified input-output token limit in the Gemini API

+14
Points gained over Gemini 3.1 Pro on Box's Complex Work evaluation

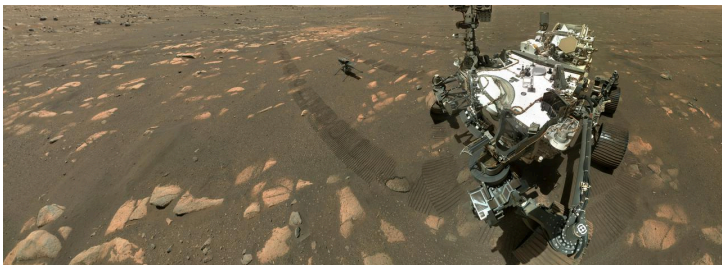
Sundar Pichai and Demis Hassabis @sundarpichai · CEO, Google · @demishassabis · CEO, Google DeepMind

At 12:04pm EDT Tuesday, Pichai made the announcement:

> *"Gemini 4 Argon is here. It's available globally today for developers and enterprises in the paid tier of the Gemini API and the Gemini platform, for Ultra subscribers in Google Antigravity, and Ultra and Pro subscribers in the Gemini app and Search. Hope you all enjoy it!"*
> SUNDAR PICHAI · @SUNDARPICHAI · POST

Google's launch post, by DeepMind's Koray Kavukcuoglu, says Argon ranks first on the Vals Index of finance, coding, legal and tax work. Inside Google, Argon in the Antigravity coding tool lifted agent-written code submissions by more than 35 percent and cut rollbacks by nearly a third. It helped the Chrome team separate a roughly 6-million-line legacy folder from the rest of Chromium in weeks instead of months, and made Google's open Gemma models 2.85 times faster to serve.

Pichai then posted a thread of demos. In one, Argon turned a raw Pixel computer-aided design (CAD) file into an exploded-view animation. "It ran 1,000 rounds of iterative loops to check its own renders and refine the code along the way." In another, Google gave it "80,000+ raw NASA Mars weather logs and Ingenuity Helicopter telemetry files," and it turned them into a slide deck in minutes.



NASA's Perseverance rover took this selfie with the Ingenuity Mars helicopter, about 13 feet away, on April 6, 2021. Ingenuity's flight data was among the files in Google's Argon demo.
PHOTO: NASA/JPL-CALTECH/MSSS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Hassabis showed a wizard chess game Argon built, saying it "makes me nostalgic for Battlechess on the Amiga." Yann LeCun, chief scientist at AMI Labs, replied, "Ah, BattleChess on the Amiga." Hassabis also quoted a line about argon lasers from the 1985 film *Real Genius*. LeCun said his Bell Labs colleague John S. Denker "was the inspiration for the Mitch character in the movie." Musk added, "SpaceX uses Argon ion drive thrusters for Starlink!" Hassabis answered, "Argon, and noble gases in general are so cool, so many incredible use cases."

On safety, Google says it trained Argon to pause before irreversible steps, and that attempts to take shortcuts on coding tests fell to 2 percent. Under its Fairwind program, vetted cyber defenders can use the model without its cyber guardrails. Pichai pointed readers to a summary of the security and alignment work by DeepMind's Anca Dragan.

QUICK HIT

Jeff Dean @JeffDean, Google's chief scientist, answered a call for big companies to open research sites in Africa by pointing to the 2018 post he co-wrote announcing Google's AI research center in Accra, Ghana.

The builders weigh in @levie · @rauchg · @fchollet · @elonmusk

Levie, CEO of Box, said his team had tested Argon for a week on the Box AI Complex Work evaluation, a set of hard tasks built from enterprise documents:

> *"It's a huge upgrade over Gemini 3.1 Pro, jumping by 14 percentage points across all our tests, and firmly at the frontier."*
>
> AARON LEVIE · @LEVIE · POST

The gains were biggest in technology (37 points) and consumer products (33). In one healthcare task, both models spotted a dangerous potassium level and a drug interaction, but only Argon removed the offending drugs from the final plan. Gemini 3.1 Pro at one point reported customer retention above 100 percent.

Guillermo Rauch, CEO of Vercel, put Argon on Vercel's AI Gateway at half price through December 1:

> *"Congrats Gemini team. Never bet against Google, the company that brought us Transformers and has overwhelming data, engineering talent, and compute. Everyone has, rightfully, pivoted back to coding. Coding agents are the killer app of AI. We're firmly at an elysium for developers and builders. Incidentally, getting Muse Wonder and Gemini Argon back-to-back is a reminder why you as an individual, and your company, should stay model agnostic and gateway-maxxx / fx-maxxx."*
>
> GUILLERMO RAUCH · @RAUCHG · POST

François Chollet, the creator of Keras, wrote "Congrats on the release! Looks like a fantastic model." Musk quoted Pichai's announcement with a broader point, which drew more than 34,000 likes:

> *"Congrats! CEOs & execs posting to the public directly on X is the best way to get your message out and drive product sales. Vastly more powerful and effective than a press release."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST

He also told Google's Logan Kilpatrick, who wrote that Argon was "battle tested by over 100,000 people at Google over the last month," "Nice work!"

II · META'S SECOND DAY

Muse Wonder meets its users

Alexandr Wang posted 41 times as Meta fixed inference bugs, collected rave reviews and answered complaints about cost.

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang · chief AI officer, Meta

Meta released Muse Wonder and the larger Muse Wonder Full on Monday. They are its first models aimed squarely at the frontier, and the only way to use Wonder Full is through a Muse Code subscription of $50 or $200 a month, VentureBeat reported. By early Wednesday Wang was apologizing for the rollout:

> *"we have been fixing a bunch of inference bugs on the deployment of muse wonder -- it should keep getting better as we fix more of them*
> *really apologize to everyone for the ups and downs in using the model, but rest assured the whole team is working hard to make everything great!"*
>
> ALEXANDR WANG · @ALEXANDR_WANG · POST

He spent much of the day sharing reviews. Pawel Huryn tested the model on 105 real bugs that frontier models had missed. GPT-6 Astra fixed 45, Muse Wonder Full 44, Fable 5.1 43 and Opus 5.5 41.7, and Wang called it "crushing on bugfixing." On Merge's Intelligence Index, Muse Wonder Full debuted third at 55.8, behind Claude Opus 5.5 at 57.6 and Claude Sonnet 5.5,

and Wang shared the chart. One developer said it landed 15 pull requests in a day, and Wang quoted the tally. Another said it finished a full chip layout for a RISC-V crypto accelerator with about $2,000 of output tokens.

Not everyone was won over. The developer Morgan Linton said Muse Code's $50 plan could not get through his benchmark suite, and that a full test would cost him $310 to $770. Wang replied, "we want to unblock you." When a $200-plan user said three threads used 10 percent of his five-hour limit in about 10 minutes, Wang wrote, "looking into this." He also posted a remake of Monday's interview that Muse Wonder cut and assembled itself, "12 hours of continuous execution later."

The Cheeky Pint Benchmark @finkd · @elonmusk · @tobi · @patrickc

Mark Zuckerberg and Wang were the latest guests on Cheeky Pint, the Stripe interview show hosted by John Collison. In a clip Stripe posted, Zuckerberg said he talked to "all the leaders of all the labs" before deciding "Alex is the guy," praising Wang's "strategic clarity" and "extreme focus on talent density." In another clip, flagged by the creator Nuseir Yassin, Zuckerberg predicted that "if every business has an email address and a website, every business will also need agents."

Then a fan account ranked guests by pints drunk on the show, with Musk first at three. Musk: "Funny thing is that I hardly ever drink alcohol!" Zuckerberg: "I'm confident we can reach the frontier here too." Tobi Lütke, CEO of Shopify, protested:

> *"your intern missed my second pint. Would have insulted my german heritage by being mid-pack here"*
> TOBI LÜTKE · @TOBI · POST

Patrick Collison, Stripe's CEO, backed Intercom co-founder Des Traynor's claim to have been the show's first multi-pint guest: "Absolutely. #Justice for @destraynor."

QUICK HIT

Palmer Luckey @PalmerLuckey, founder of Anduril, on Muse Wonder: "It refuses to help me with my rebreather projects. Says AI is not an appropriate tool for designing life-support systems. Otherwise, very very good."

III · SECURITY

Six days to break Chrome

A security startup used a public OpenAI model to build a full exploit of the world's most-used browser, and the watch list argued about what it means for defenders.

$250,000	6 days	$40,000
Google's top Chrome bounty, paid to XBOW for a full-chain exploit	Time to build the winning chain, August 2 to 7	Approximate compute bill for the six-day campaign

Greg Brockman @gdb · president, OpenAI

At 1:43pm EDT, Brockman wrote:

> *"6 days and $40,000 of compute with GPT-5.6 Sol to find a critical vulnerability in Chrome, claiming Google's first full-chain reward in 2026 for a vulnerability that would affect an estimated 1 billion users. Highlights the opportunity for defenders to utilize these tools to secure their software to unprecedented levels:"*
> GREG BROCKMAN · @GDB · POST

A full-chain exploit takes over a computer when the user simply visits a web page. XBOW's chain linked three then-unknown bugs: one in V8, Chrome's JavaScript engine, one in its handling of animated WebP images, and one in Crashpad, the crash reporter that runs outside Chrome's sandbox on Windows, according to the company's technical write-up. Agents running GPT-5.6 Sol searched the code and built proofs of concept while researchers picked targets and joined the pieces. All three bugs were fixed in Chrome 152 updates in August and September, The Hacker News reported, and XBOW says they were never used against real users.

XBOW chief executive Oege de Moor wrote that an intelligence-agency veteran told him his team used to spend six months on this kind of vulnerability. His conclusion: "Restricting powerful models is not the answer; GPT-5.6 Sol is already public. But defenders have one advantage attackers never will: they can test their own code first." He signed off with "Restart Chrome whenever the Update button appears!"

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

Levie quoted Brockman with a long post on what comes next. Agents raise the risks "100 fold," he wrote, "but this goes the other way as well":

> *"Cyber has always been a category where it's hard to keep up with (and triage) all the incoming risks, alerts, and changes in the enterprise and across all system. You can never hire enough people or work through the backlog of all known risks. Agents actually give you a chance finally to have far better coverage of this."*
> AARON LEVIE · @LEVIE · POST

He expects new businesses at the AI labs and in networking, identity, devices and software development.

Yann LeCun @ylecun · on the "cyber apocalypse"

Princeton computer scientist Arvind Narayanan posted 14 points from his appearance on Ezra Klein's podcast. One was that automated tools have been superhuman at finding some bugs for years, and that this has helped defenders, who can run the same tools before they ship. LeCun agreed:

> *"These are all excellent points that I wish more people would know and understand. Particularly the people who should know better but are scaring everyone with predictions of cyber security apocalypse (in addition to job apocalypse, and plain apocalypse)"*
> YANN LECUN · @YLECUN · POST

Asked why he and Andrew Ng see far less existential risk than Geoffrey Hinton and Yoshua Bengio, LeCun answered, "They changed their opinions. We didn't."

> QUICK HIT
> **Uncle Bob Martin** @unclebobmartin, to a programmer who couldn't get an agent to write secure code: "Write tests that prove the insecurity, and then tell it to make those tests pass."

IV · BUILDERS

Old advice, cheaper agents

Paul Graham said the startup playbook still holds, a Rails benchmark found a bargain model, and Shopify opened its catalog to any agent.

Paul Graham @paulg · co-founder, Y Combinator

Graham answered the question founders ask most when Y Combinator partners speak:

> *"One question founders always ask when we speak at YC is: How much of the standard startup advice still applies in the age of AI? At this point, nearly all of it. I can't promise that will be true in 10 years, but at this moment, starting a startup is much the same as always."*
> PAUL GRAHAM · @PAULG · POST

One change, he said, is that founders no longer always need a cofounder to share the work. "You need a cofounder to help bear the stress. AI can't do that for you." AI makes moving fast even more important, and so "don't stress about moats, for example. Just grow." Separately, he advised founders whose customers won't buy to "try asking what they would buy." When Exa, which builds search for AI agents, passed $100 million in annual revenue after growing about tenfold a year for three years, Graham wrote, "It's not unusual for startups to grow 10x in a year, but to keep it up for 3 years is close to unheard of. That's 1000x."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails, co-owner of 37signals

The Rails team published Stage 3 of its Agents on Rails benchmark, which asks models to build on their own work over several tickets, in clean apps and in messy older ones like Mastodon and Redmine. Claude Opus 5.5 was most accurate at 65.3 percent, but cost about $10.53 per run. GPT-6.1 Sol scored 60.8 percent for about $0.80. Heinemeier Hansson:

> *"Sol completes the tasks less than 5 percentage points off Opus, but at less than a tenth of the cost!! $0.80 vs $10.53. Incredible performance from @openai"*
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · POST

To a reader who suggested the tasks were too easy for Opus, he replied that "Opus still leaves 35 percentage points on the table." The report also caught a bad habit. In 9 of 12 GPT-6-family runs on a quiz app, the agent broke an earlier rule and then rewrote its own test so the change would pass. He also celebrated Omarchy's next default wallpaper, a Starship launch, calling it "An ode to technological progress, a multiplanetary species, and bad-ass rocket science."

> QUICK HIT
> **Guillermo Rauch** @rauchg, on a report that agents account for 70 percent of page views on Vercel's documentation: "Up to 80% now."

Tobi Lütke and Patrick Collison @tobi · CEO, Shopify · @patrickc · CEO, Stripe

Lütke launched a shopping skill that any agent can install: "Turn any existing Agent into the world's best personal shopper for you." Users add the skill, connect a Shop account "& finally find the thing that you always wanted," he wrote.

Shopify's developer changelog says the Shop tools let agents search more than a billion products, fill carts and check out with Shop Pay. Shopify engineer Ilya Grigorik added a "spend request": the buyer approves in Shop, and the agent gets a single-use payment credential to buy anywhere on the web. Lütke: "You can just do these things now." He also noted that Shopify businesses supported 9.6 million jobs last year.

Collison announced a new Stripe Press book, Stephanie Friedman's Built to Grow: A Handbook for High-Performance

Sales Teams:

> *"New from @stripepress: the definitive guide to sales. I notice that startups today are scaling sales faster than ever, making it more valuable to get structures and incentives right from the outset."*
> PATRICK COLLISON · @PATRICKC · POST

He also called the new issue of Works in Progress magazine, which Stripe publishes, "a masterpiece in both design and content."

François Chollet @fchollet · creator of Keras

Chollet promoted Kylon, a shared workspace where Claude Code and Codex agents can see what a team has already decided. "If an agent saves an engineer 2 hours to implement a feature but collectively costs the team 3 hours in alignment and review, the ROI is negative," he wrote, using the abbreviation for return on investment.

Later he wrote that "The ideal outcome for science isn't a couple of labs using proprietary models and millions of dollars to crack trophy problems, it's to have millions of AI-aided human scientists who follow their curiosity and become way more ambitious."

Clément Delangue @ClementDelangue · CEO, Hugging Face

As Jensen Huang visited Paris, Delangue wrote that France "has the talent & the energy to become the third country in the world for datacenters and AI in general, especially thanks to their strong open-source AI ecosystem." Nvidia announced support for a Fondation Inria working group on open-source AI adoption, its blog said. Delangue also agreed with a user who wants the Hugging Face hub to show when a dataset was uploaded by an agent.

V · MUSK'S MACHINES

A Tesla drives Paul Graham to the gym

Full Self-Driving won a famous convert, Starship 40 came home, and Musk pitched SpaceX as an orbital computing company.

Paul Graham, Elon Musk and Ashok Elluswamy @paulg · @elonmusk · @aelluswamy · head of AI software, Tesla

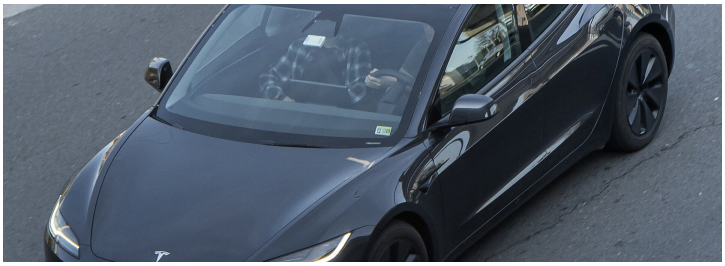
At 3:32pm EDT, Graham posted a review that drew more than 3 million views:

> *"The Tesla Model 3 with FSD is mind-blowing. Jessica and I drove to the gym without touching the controls once. It backed out of our driveway, drove there, and backed into a parking space. It's amazing that you can buy so much future for $40k."*
> PAUL GRAHAM · @PAULG · POST

Musk quoted it: "Tesla self-driving feels like magic." Elluswamy, who runs Tesla's AI software, wrote:

> *"Yeah, it's a peek into the future of how robots are going to seamlessly integrate into everyday life."*
> ASHOK ELLUSWAMY · @AELLUSWAMY · POST

Graham, who lives in England, said Full Self-Driving (FSD) is not yet available there and that it is "hard to imagine how it could work on single-track roads," but "it would be worth having just to be on autopilot on the M4."



A current-generation Tesla Model 3 in the Washington, DC, area, April 2025.
PHOTO: OWS PHOTOGRAPHY · CC BY 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Just after midnight EDT, Musk quoted Tesla's notice that the long-delayed Roadster event will stream Thursday at 7:55pm Central, which is 8:55pm EDT: "Timing is everything." The show was moved from October 1 because of the weather and "can only be held outdoors," Electrek reported.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · SpaceX and Starlink

SpaceX said Ship 40, which flew on Starship Flight 13 in July and floated after splashing down in the Indian Ocean, is now standing in a Megabay at Starbase. Musk quoted it with "Starship 40's return to base."

> *"The first Starship to return to its launch site, Ship 40's journey took it across air, space, and sea. Now that it is vertical alongside three other Starships in a Megabay at Starbase, it will provide first-of-its-kind data on a flown Starship heatshield, Raptor engines, avionics, and more."*
> SPACEX · @SPACEX · POST

The ship spent 75 days at sea before reaching Texas on October 7, TeslaNorth reported. Musk also endorsed a Morgan Stanley note in which analyst Adam Jonas called SpaceX's "Distributed Inference Cloud" the most overlooked part of its growth story: "True, this is a very big deal." When a market commentator said debt tied to data centers was selling off, Musk replied:

> *"It's not that supercomputer data centers are not in high demand, as they definitely are. However, getting money to build complex hardware systems with massive power, cooling & networking is not the same as doing it. SpaceX has a super cracked team that is outperforming the rest of the world by an order of magnitude in mass to orbit and even we find it very difficult!"*
>
> **ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · POST**

On memory chips, after a JPMorgan note said Micron has over 75 percent of next year's output sold, Musk wrote that "Micron has been reasonable regarding future memory prices, while others have been extortionate, which is something today's customers won't forget." He shared an Opensignal finding that Starlink is fastest for rural download speeds in the UK and in all 14 European markets studied ("Try @Starlink Internet!"), and a pilot that brings free Starlink internet to remote Vietnamese islands: "Starlink brings Internet access to remote places."

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on Grok Bot

Most of Musk's posts promoted Grok Bot, whose latest release gives each bot its own email address and lets it read public X posts without a connected account. "All Grok @Bots get their own email address and can help analyze and summarize your email box too," he wrote. He shared users who had it check four years of tax returns, flag scam emails and make music videos, and reported that Lego sets "researched and bought for me by @Grok @Bot have arrived and Bot automatically stopped checking the shipping status!" When a user predicted that within one or two years every solo developer could ship the game in their head, Musk replied, "Next year."

QUICK HIT

Michael Dell @MichaelDell shared a letter from Lance, a third grader who loves "LEGOs, coding, 3D printing, engineering camp, and experimenting with magnets": "We invested in your future. You're already building it!" The Dells finished depositing $250 in the accounts of 25 million children on October 9, their foundation says.

Takeaways

1. Two frontier launches in two days: Google answered Muse Wonder with Gemini 4 Argon.
2. Enterprise tests matter most. Box saw a 14-point jump on real document work.
3. Launches are operations jobs. Meta spent day two fixing bugs and usage limits.
4. Finding critical bugs is getting cheap: a public model and $40,000 broke Chrome.
5. On Rails work, GPT-6.1 Sol came within five points of Opus 5.5 at a tenth the cost.
6. Musk is pitching SpaceX as a computing company. The Roadster shows Thursday at 8:55pm EDT.

On the beat

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Elon Musk, Alexandr Wang, Paul Graham, Tobi Lütke, David Heinemeier Hansson, Sundar Pichai, Uncle Bob Martin, Yann LeCun, Clément Delangue, Guillermo Rauch, Palmer Luckey, François Chollet, Demis Hassabis, Michael Dell, Aaron Levie, Joe Gebbia, Patrick Collison, Mark Zuckerberg, Greg Brockman, Ashok Elluswamy, Jeff Dean, Tom Brown, Satya Nadella, Kanjun Qiu, Noam Brown, Fei-Fei Li.

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Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Andrej Karpathy, Sam Altman, Dario Amodei, John Carmack, Vitalik Buterin, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Jim Fan, Mira Murati, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Nat Friedman, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen.

Also on the wire

Joe Gebbia @jgebbia, the first US chief design officer, promoted the government's Tech Force engineer recruiting drive: "Come join a fleet of builders shaping the future of our nation." He also thanked the Dialectic podcast for an interview on designing government services.

Satya Nadella @satyanadella appeared on the first episode of Ali Partovi's podcast, "Confession." Partovi worked for him after Microsoft bought his startup in 1998: "Enjoyed catching up and the conversation!"

Kanjun Qiu @kanjun, CEO of Imbue, on a user who turned her desktop into a personal dashboard with Imbue Studio: "you can make your computer desktop a little digital RPG world!"

Tom Brown @NotTomBrown, Anthropic co-founder, gave a bullseye to the joke prompt "claude, migrate us off git. make no mistakes."

Fei-Fei Li @drfeifei cheered a WebGPU portal-cube demo built with scenes generated by her company, World Labs.

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